

Learner Voice and Choice Observation Tool

A teacher-friendly rubric for observing whether learners understand goals, make meaningful choices, explain their thinking and reflect on progress.

Downloadable professional learning asset | Finnish-Pedagogy | EDUFI-aligned | FINEEC-benchmarked

Resource type	Observation rubric
Author	Finland Creative Education Institute (FCEI)
Recommended users	teachers, school leaders, facilitators, TVET providers and education teams
Internal course links	C02 Learner Agency and the Joy of Learning; C04 Formative Assessment and Feedback; C09 Teacher Inquiry and Evidence-Informed Practice

Purpose

Use this tool to observe how learner voice and choice appear in a real lesson. It helps teachers distinguish between superficial choice and purposeful choice connected to a learning goal.

EDUFI-aligned use

The tool supports learner participation, goal awareness, reflection and local classroom routines that help learners become active participants in their own learning.

FINEEC-benchmarked use

The rubric can be used for developmental peer observation and teacher inquiry. It should support professional dialogue, not judgement or ranking.

Key definitions

Learner voice means learners can explain, question, contribute and reflect. Meaningful choice means choices that affect process, product, strategy, collaboration or evidence while staying connected to the goal. Agency means learners understand the goal, act with purpose and reflect on progress.

How to use

Observe a 20-30 minute segment of teaching. Rate each indicator from 1 to 4. Record evidence, not opinions. Finish with one teacher reflection and one possible improvement action.

Working tool

Observation dimension	1 Emerging	2 Developing	3 Secure	4 Strong	Evidence note
Goal clarity	Learners depend fully on teacher direction	Goal is stated but not used	Most learners can explain the goal	Learners use the goal to guide choices	
Meaningful choice	Choice is absent or cosmetic	Learners choose surface features	Learners choose task route or support	Learners justify choices and adjust strategy	
Learner explanation	Few learners explain thinking	Some learners answer teacher prompts	Learners explain strategies when asked	Learners initiate explanation and questions	
Reflection	Reflection is absent	Reflection is brief and general	Learners identify progress or difficulty	Learners decide a next step from evidence	
Teacher response	Teacher controls all decisions	Teacher occasionally invites choice	Teacher uses learner input to adjust support	Teacher builds routines for shared responsibility	

Model completed example

During a reading lesson, learners choose between a diagram, paragraph plan or oral rehearsal before writing. Observation notes show that choice improves participation, but some learners choose the easiest option. The teacher revises the routine by asking learners to explain why their choice fits the goal.

Reflection and improvement prompts

- Which choices in the lesson were meaningful?
- What evidence showed learner voice?



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- How can the teacher help learners choose responsibly?

Author bio

Finland Creative Education Institute (FCEI) is a digital professional learning platform that supports educators, school leaders, TVET providers, institutions and learning communities through Finnish-Pedagogy training, EDUFI-aligned curriculum language, FINEEC-benchmarked quality improvement practice and practical evidence-based implementation tools.

Suggested course links

- C02 Learner Agency and the Joy of Learning: <https://www.fcei.eu/courses/c02-learner-agency-joy-of-learning>
- C04 Formative Assessment and Feedback: <https://www.fcei.eu/courses/c04-formative-assessment>
- C09 Teacher Inquiry and Evidence-Informed Practice: <https://www.fcei.eu/courses/c09-teacher-inquiry>